



Facebook pic collection

Facebook user base collectively has uploaded over 250 billion photos since its launch. <http://dgit.in/14zGUny>



WP Ranks 2nd

Windows Phone is India's second largest smartphone platform: IDC <http://dgit.in/1fbCASu>

Processing Mediatek's future

We caught up with Dr. Finbarr Moynihan, the General Manager of International Sales and Marketing for Mediatek and asked him a range of questions from Mediatek's outlook on the Indian market to the upcoming octa-core SoCs.

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MediaTek has been powering most of the budget and value smartphone offerings from Indian brands like Micromax and Xolo. When do you see Mediatek's SOC's finding a place inside global brands like Samsung, HTC, Sony and Nokia?

We are very pleased with the progress of many of the strong local brands – such as Micromax and Xolo in India – over the past years in progressing their portfolios from feature phones to now include entry and higher-tier smartphones as well – such as the high-tier Canvas family from Micromax that has been quite successful in the market. As well as that, we are very pleased with the smartphones from many top 10 OEM brands worldwide that are shipping with MediaTek – including LGE, Motorola, ZTE, Huawei and others like Acer, Lenovo, Alcatel and Coolpad. We remain open and enthusiastic about potential engagement with other Tier 1 OEMs, but at this stage do not have any more specifics to announce.

The GPU performance for the MT6589 series has been particularly weak when compared to the Tegra 3 and Qualcomm Snapdragon series of quad-core SOC's, when can we expect Mediatek to match and hopefully outperform them?

We believe that the MT6589, launched late last year, delivered the right level of GPU performance for mid-high tier smartphones – that still aim to hit affordable price points for the consumers. Some of the mentioned competitor products are more targeted at the very-high end premium models where prices can often be \$500 or more – we are aiming for a different segment with the MT6589. Indeed, for 2013, we expect that 25-35% of our smartphone shipments will be based on our quad-core



Dr. Finbarr Moynihan, GM, International Sales and Marketing

platforms, predominantly the MT6589. That said, we continue to see the need for increased GPU performance and indeed our new mobile processor, the MT8135, takes the integrated graphics performance to a new level – being the first mobile processor to integrate the latest Imagination Technologies PowerVR Series 6 GPU core.

So far Mediatek SOC's have been powering Android devices, can we expect them to power Windows mobile devices in future? Windows is coming up as an operating system but for now they have low volumes as compared to Android. We foresee some good devices coming with Windows Phone and expect they will take a certain percentage of the market. At the moment we do not support Windows, and are focused on Android. However, MediaTek has always been open to tapping into new opportunities, and when the time comes we can support Windows in the future. We continue to

monitor the progress of other Linux-based OS, such as Firefox OS, Ubuntu, Tizen – but do not expect significant market share in the short term.

Apart from smartphones and tablets, which other device categories are you betting on the most for future growth and implementation of your higher-end SOC solutions?

At this stage, we remain heavily focused on the smartphone and tablet devices & platforms. At MediaTek, we also have a strong portfolio of home entertainment platforms – such as DTV and Blu-ray DVD, where we see the growing trend towards smart, connected devices that also require more CPU, GPU, multimedia and applications processing capabilities with higher-level operating systems. We expect connected, smart TVs and other home-entertainment devices like STB, DVD, IP-streaming boxes to continue to drive growth for our platforms and products.

Two years from now, how do you see yourself positioned against the likes of Qualcomm and Intel as the two major SOC players? Also, while Intel has been late to the party, their upcoming SOC solutions seem to look very promising in terms of performance and power draw. How do you see yourself competing against Intel in future?

There is always competition in this business, we try not to focus on what our competitors are doing, we strive ourselves to deliver better platforms, more features. We believe that if we deliver better products and a reference solution and a support structure, it will allow us to support our customers to adopt those products. We will be successful, that is what we believe, rather than concentrating on what our competitors are doing.

Dr. Moynihan spoke to us extensively on other topics as well. To read the entire interview, go to: <http://dgit.in/1aiOOX2>